

Victor of Vita 484

<i>Latin</i>	<i>English</i>
## Historia II.41–44 — Eugenius of Carthage: the faith is the whole world's cause; the Roman church the head of all the churches (A.D. 484; CSEL 7, pp. 40–42) [[p. 40]] Tractatum est quid fieret. Nullum inuenit remedium imminens calamitas, nisi a sancto Eugenio rationabilis, si cor barbarum molliretur, suggerenda daretur tali textu conscripta. [41] 'Quotiens animae uel uitae aeternae ac fidei Christianae causa tractatur, intrepide, sicut regalis prouidentia conpromisit, necesse est quod conpetit suggeratur. Nuper potestas regia per Uitarit notarium paruitatem meam ammonere dignata est, qui nobis merito religionis ac fidei praeceptum eius in ecclesia praesente clero et plebe recensuit. Ex cuius tenore cognouimus ad omnes coëpiscopos meos praeceptum regium similiter emanasse, ut die constituta pro disputatione fidei ueniatur; quod nos uenerabiliter accepisse suggessimus. Cui praefato notario humilitas mea suggessit, debere etiam transmarinarum omnium partium, qui nobiscum sunt in una religione uel communione consortes, agnoscere, quia ubique regno eius obtemperant uniuersi; maxime quod totius mundi sit	## Historia II.41–44 — Eugenius of Carthage: the faith is the whole world's cause; the Roman church the head of all the churches (A.D. 484; CSEL 7, pp. 40–42) [[p. 40]] It was debated what should be done. The impending calamity found no remedy, except that a reasoned representation should be submitted by holy Eugenius — in the hope that the barbarian's heart might be softened — drawn up in the following terms: [41] "As often as the cause of the soul, or of eternal life, or of the Christian faith is treated, it is necessary — fearlessly, as the royal foresight has promised — that what is fitting be submitted. Recently the royal power deigned to admonish my littleness through the notary Uitarit, who, for the sake of religion and faith, recited to us his [the king's] command in the church, in the presence of the clergy and people. From its tenor we learned that the royal command had likewise gone forth to all my fellow-bishops, that on an appointed day there should be a coming-together for a disputation on the faith; and we submitted that we had received this reverently. To the aforesaid notary my humility submitted that [the bishops] of all the regions beyond the sea also, who are partakers with us in one religion and communion, ought to take cognizance [of it], since everywhere all are subject to his rule — especially because it is the cause of

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causa, non specialis [42] prouinciarum Africanarum tantummodo. Et quia secundo responso suggerendam me promisi oblatum, merito suppliciter peto magnificentiam tuam, ut ad domni et clementissimi regis aures memoratam suggestionem meam perferre digneris, quo eius clementia dignanter agnoscat, nos disputationem legis cum adiutorio dei nullatenus declinare uel fugere, sed sine uniuersitatis adsensu nos non debere asserendae fidei nostrae causas adsumere. Quod petimus ut benignitate quantus est et [[p. 41]] iustitia sapientiae suae dignetur annuere. Data ab Eugenio episcopo ecclesiae catholicae Carthaginis’. [43] (II, 15) Sed cum haec suggestio a beato Eugenio offerretur, ille iam qui conceperat dolorem, urgebatur iniquitatem grauius parturire, et ita sancto uiro Eugenio episcopo per Obadum praepositum regni sui mandasse uidetur: ‘subde mihi uniuersum orbem terrarum, ut sub potestate mea totus mundus redigatur, et facio, o Eugeni, quod dicis’. Ad quod beatus Eugenius respondit ut potuit: ‘quod rationem’, inquit, ‘non habet, dici non debuit: sic est hoc quomodo si dicatur homini, ut per aera feratur et uolitet, quod moris non est humanae naturae. Dixi enim: si nostram fidem, quae una et uera est, potestas regis cognoscere desiderat, mittat ad amicos suos: scribam et ego fratribus meis, ut ueniant coëpiscopi mei, qui uobis nobiscum communem fidem nostram ualeant demonstrare, et praecipue ecclesia Romana, quae caput est omnium ecclesiarum’. Ad haec	the whole world, and not peculiar [42] to the African provinces alone. And because I promised in a second reply that I would present a submission, I deservedly and suppliantly beg your magnificence that you would deign to convey my aforesaid representation to the ears of the lord and most clement king, so that his clemency may graciously acknowledge that we in no way decline or flee the disputation of the law with the help of God, but that we ought not to take up the pleading of our faith without the assent of the whole [Church]. This we beg that he may deign to grant with such benignity and [[p. 41]] justice as befits his wisdom. Given by Eugenius, bishop of the catholic church of Carthage.” [43] (II, 15) But when this representation was being presented by blessed Eugenius, that man — who had already conceived grief — was being driven to bring forth iniquity more grievously; and so he seems to have sent word to the holy man, bishop Eugenius, through Obadus, the overseer of his kingdom: “Subject to me the whole world, that the entire world may be brought under my power, and I will do, O Eugenius, what you say.” To which blessed Eugenius replied as best he could: “What has no reason,” he said, “ought not to be said: this is just as if it were said to a man that he should be carried through the air and fly about, which is not the custom of human nature. For what I said was this: if the royal power desires to know our faith, which is one and true, let him send to his friends; I too will write to my brethren, that my fellow-bishops may come who, together with us, may be able to demonstrate to you our common faith — and especially the Roman church, which is the head of all the churches.” To this Obadus [said]: “So

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Obadus: ‘ergo tu et domnus meus rex similes [44] estis’? Eugenius episcopus dixit: ‘ego non sum similis regis, sed dixi: si ueram cognoscere desiderat fidem, scribat amicis suis, ut dirigant nostros catholicos episcopos, et ego scribo coëpiscopis meis, quia catholicae uniuersae una est causa’. Hoc agebat Eugenius, non quia deessent in Africam, qui aduersariorum obiecta refellerent, sed ut illi uenissent, qui alieni ab eorum dominatu maiorem fiduciam libertatis haberent [[p. 42]] pariterque oppressionis nostrae calumnias uniuersis terris et populis nuntiarent. ## Liber fidei catholicae, close (Historia II.100–101) — the faith founded on the fellowship of all the catholic churches in this world (pp. 70–71) [[p. 70]] [100] (III, 23) Sit ergo nobis secundum salutaris baptismi confessionem fides integra trinitatis, sit una deuotio pietatis, nec more gentilium potestatum diuersitates opinemur, aut creaturam quantum ad deitatem in trinitate suspicemur. Sed nec Iudaeorum scandalo moueamur, qui filium dei negant, qui spiritum non adorant, sed potius perfectam trinitatem adorantes et magnificantes, sicut in mysteriis ore nostro dicimus, ita conscientia teneamus: sanctus sanctus sanctus dominus deus sabaoth. Ter dicentes sanctus unam omni-[[p. 71]]potentiam confitemur, quia una est religio, una glorificatio trinitatis, ut audiamus apostolos, sicut audierunt Corinthii: gratia domini nostri Iesu Christi et dilectio dei et communicatio spiritus sancti cum omnibus uobis. [101] Haec est fides	then, are you and my lord the king equals?” Bishop Eugenius said: “I am not the king’s equal; but what I said was: if he desires to know the true faith, let him write to his friends, that they may direct our catholic bishops hither, and I will write to my fellow-bishops, since the cause of the whole catholic [body] is one.” This Eugenius did, not because there were lacking in Africa men who might refute the objections of the adversaries, but so that those men might come who, being strangers to their [the Vandals’] dominion, would have greater confidence of liberty [[p. 42]] and would likewise announce to all lands and peoples the calumnies of our oppression. ## Liber fidei catholicae, close (Historia II.100–101) — the faith founded on the fellowship of all the catholic churches in this world (pp. 70–71) [[p. 70]] [100] (III, 23) Let there be for us, therefore, in accordance with the confession of saving baptism, a whole and entire faith of the Trinity; let there be one devotion of piety; and let us not, after the manner of the gentiles, imagine diversities of powers, nor suspect anything created, as regards deity, within the Trinity. But neither let us be moved by the scandal of the Jews, who deny the Son of God, who do not adore the Spirit; but rather, adoring and magnifying the perfect Trinity, as we say with our mouth in the [sacred] mysteries, so let us hold with our conscience: Holy, holy, holy, Lord God of hosts. Saying “Holy” three times, [[p. 71]] we confess one omnipotence, since there is one religion, one glorification of the Trinity — that we may listen to the apostles, as the Corinthians listened [to them]: The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, and the love of God, and the communion of the Holy Spirit be with you all. [101] This is

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nostra, euangelicis et apostolicis traditionibus et omnium, quae in hoc mundo sunt, catholicarum ecclesiarum societate fundata, in qua nos per gratiam dei omnipotentis permanere usque ad finem uitae huius confidimus et speramus. Directa duodecimo Kal. Maiarum per Ianuarius Zattarensem [marg. <i>a. 484</i>] Uillaticum a Casis Medianis episcopos Numidiaie, Bonifatium Foratianensem et Bonifatium Gatianensem episcopos Bizacenos.	our faith, founded upon the evangelical and apostolic traditions and upon the fellowship of all the catholic churches that are in this world, in which [faith] we trust and hope, by the grace of Almighty God, to remain until the end of this life. Delivered on the twelfth [day] before the Kalends of May [20 April, marg. <i>a. 484</i>] by [the hands of] Ianuarius of Zattara [and] Uillaticus of Casae Medianae, bishops of Numidia, [and] Bonifatius of Foratiana and Bonifatius of Gatiana, bishops of Byzacena.